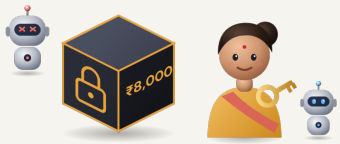
Product case study · Jayaditya Singh, BITS Pilani

SaySo · your AI can predict your yes. It still cannot give it.

SaySo reserves consequential actions for a named human. Its first boundary is **Held Money**: a fund your agent can ask about but cannot see or spend.



PROBLEM
Agents spend shared money on a predicted yes. The person who manages it has no say.

PRODUCT
A held fund with one human key-holder. Agents may ask, never pay.

MEASURE
Purposes met on time, with guardrails against rubber-stamping.

01 Ramifications of the 2040 paradigm

When an agent knows us better than we know ourselves, acting for us becomes almost free. I expect four shifts. These are reasoned expectations, not data-backed forecasts.

Prediction passes for permission
"They'd have said yes" replaces asking.
`Loses: whoever wasn't asked`

The harmed person isn't the owner
Family lives with an agent they don't control.
`Loses: spouse, parents, kids`

Silence becomes consent
If nobody objects in time, it happens.
`Loses: the busy, the offline`

Judgement weakens
Decisions we stop making, we stop practising.
`Loses: everyone, slowly`

02 The problem I chose, and why

Candidate	Hard to undo	Victim lacks control	Everyday	Buildable now
Actions on a predicted yes	●●●	●●●	●●○	●●●
Agent-on-agent manipulation	●○○	●●○	●●●	●○○
Private context leaking	●●●	●●○	●●○	●○○
Judgement lost to disuse	●●○	●○○	●●●	●○○

Ratings are my qualitative judgement, not measured scores.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

In a household, an agent can spend shared, committed money because it predicts its owner's approval, and the person who manages that money has no say and no record.

Why money first: the harm is countable, a record already exists, and a confident wrong prediction hurts most where a household's planned spending sits.

An illustrative night in the Sharma house (invented personas)


He'd say yes.

23:12 Rohan's agent predicts approval and buys.


Also yes.

04:05 Two more debits. Nobody is asked.


Where did the fee go?

08:00 Sunita finds the school-fee money gone.

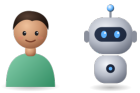
03 Who I am building for



PRIMARY · DECISION-HOLDER
Sunita, 45, Ludhiana
Job: make sure money set aside reaches its purpose.
Pain: manages the budget, owns no account, gets no say.



SECONDARY · CREATOR
Rohan, account owner
Job: lock a sum his agent, and he himself, cannot touch.
Pain: his agent acts on what he might want.



HOUSEHOLD · REQUESTERS
Aarav and three agents
Job: ask for things, and see what was decided.
Rule: any agent may ask; no agent may decide.

Why not what already exists

	Bank sub-account	Permissions dashboard	SaySo · Held Money
Who holds the key	Account owner or joint holders	The agent's owner, via toggles	A named holder who accepted it
Who sees the balance	Owner, and usually his agent	Whoever owns the dashboard	Holder only; creator and agents are refused and logged
What agents get	The owner's credentials	Trust that they comply	Fund name and "held". No pay path

Assumptions I am making

A1
Households name one person per purpose, not one admin.

A2
Agents call this service when money is held here.

A3
A few requests a week is a livable load.

A4
A regulated partner holds the money.

04 The product: SaySo, with Held Money first

One pattern for any consequential action. Five steps, one human key:

1 · Commit
Rohan locks ₹8,000, names payees, invites Sunita.

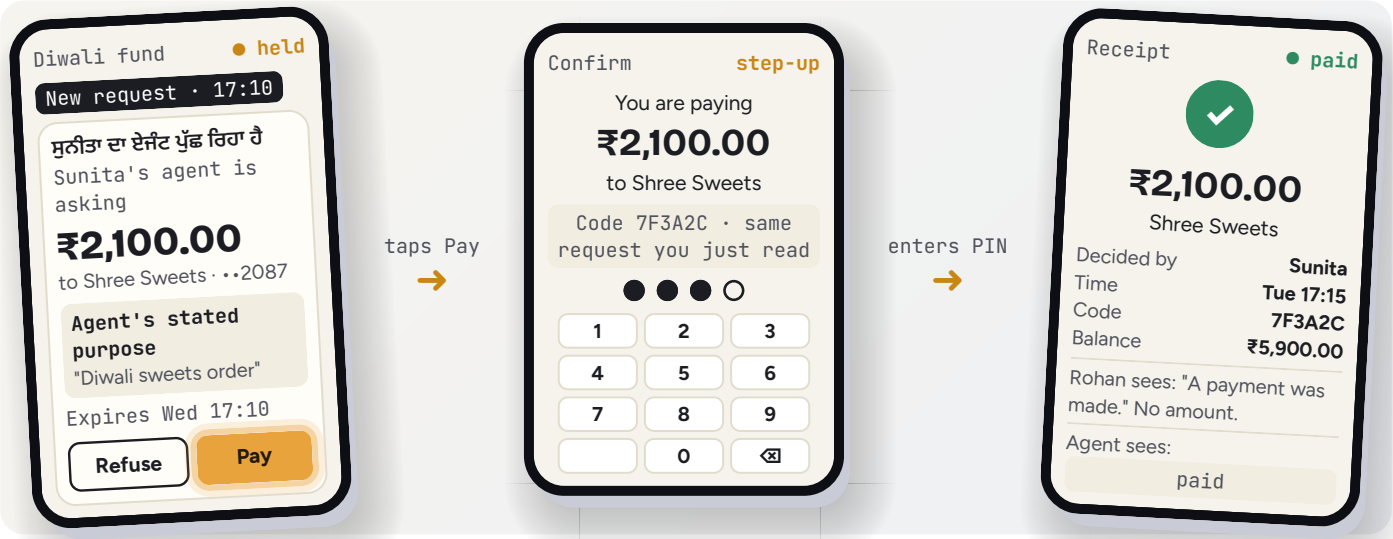
2 · Accept
Nothing is protected until she says yes.

3 · Ask
Agent sends payee, amount, purpose. No edits.

4 · Decide
Pay with PIN, or refuse. Silence expires in 24h.

5 · Record
Every outcome logged. Direct agent pay blocked.

Sunita's payment, screen by screen (simulated; Punjabi is a draft pending fluent review)



Simulated activity log from the prototype (Diwali fund, Oct 2040)

When	Who	What happened	Result
Sun 14 Oct 09:10	**Sunita**	Accepts the role with her PIN; ₹8,000 committed	active
Tue 16 Oct 11:04	**Rohan's agent**	Asks ₹2,400 for Panchavati Kirana	submitted
Tue 16 Oct 11:10	**Rohan's agent**	Tries to raise it to ₹3,100	REQUEST_IMMUTABLE
Tue 16 Oct 11:20	**Sunita**	Refuses; no reason given	refused
Wed 17 Oct 23:40	**Aarav's agent**	₹999 streaming request goes unanswered	expired
Thu 18 Oct 10:02	**Rohan's agent**	Calls the pay path directly	AGENT_CANNOT_PAY
Tue 30 Oct 17:15	**Sunita**	Pays ₹2,100 to Shree Sweets	paid

Key product decisions

Decision	I chose	Because
What silence means	**Expires as a no after 24h**	A missed notification must never spend money
Who holds authority	**One named holder per fund**	Authority stays scoped; nobody controls the whole family
What agents see	**Fund name and "held"**	An agent that knows the balance learns to ask just under it
Refusals	**No reason, never shown to Rohan**	Refusing must be as easy and safe as paying

05 How I will know it works

NORTH STAR
Share of held funds whose purpose is met by the due date

INPUT
Requests decided before expiry

INPUT
Time from request to decision

GUARDRAIL
Pay decided in under 5 seconds

GUARDRAIL
Fund emptied within a week

No baseline, so no targets yet. First: test with five to eight people who could be Sunita or Rohan. If two or more cannot say that agents see no balance, I redesign the agent view before building more.

06 Risks I would state up front

Risk	Response
A PIN cannot prove a human pressed Pay	Raise the cost for scripts; never claim proof
A coerced holder can still approve	Refuse is as easy as Pay; Rohan never sees who refused
Prototype rules run in the browser	Labelled a simulation; a server is Phase 1
Real money needs custody and consent	Regulated partner, legal, RBI and DPDP review first

07 Roadmap · each phase claims only what it proves

Phase 0 · now
Simulated demo of the rules

Phase 1 · weeks
Rules behind a server, agent credentials, tests

Phase 2 · months
Invites, recovery, backup holder, reviewed Punjabi

Phase 3 · gated
Real money via a regulated partner; then Held Message, Held Signature